

أَعُوذُ بِاللَّهِ مِنَ الشَّيْطَانِ الرَّجِيمِ
بِسْمِ اللَّهِ الرَّحْمَنِ الرَّحِيمِ

Lisan ul Quran — Lecture 24

The complex Murakkab Idafi

1. Hadith

لَا تَزُولُ قَدَمَا ابْنِ آدَمَ يَوْمَ الْقِيَامَةِ مِنْ عِنْدِ رَبِّهِ حَتَّى يُسْأَلَ عَنْ خَمْسٍ: عَنْ عُمُرِهِ فِيمَ أَفْنَاهُ، وَعَنْ شَبَابِهِ فِيمَ أَبْلَاهُ،
وَمَالِهِ مِنْ أَيْنَ اكْتَسَبَهُ وَفِيمَ أَنْفَقَهُ، وَمَاذَا عَمِلَ فِيمَا عَلِمَ

(narrated from 'Abdullah ibn Mas'ud, may Allah be pleased with him)

Translation: The two feet of the son of Adam will not move from before his Lord on the Day of Resurrection until he is questioned about five things: about his life, in what he spent it; about his youth, in what he wore it out; about his wealth, from where he earned it and in what he spent it; and about his knowledge, how far he acted upon it.

Its relevance to the lesson: At the very beginning of this hadith comes قَدَمَا ابْنِ آدَمَ, which is made up of three nouns. This is the subject of the present lesson.

2. A recap of the Murakkab Idafi

The word *idafi* comes from إِضَافَةٌ, and *idafah* means relation or connection. A construction of at least two nouns in which one is related to another is called a *Murakkab Idafi*.

- The noun that is related is called the *Mudaf*.
- The noun to which the relation is made is called the *Mudaf Ilayh*.
- Unlike Urdu, in Arabic the *Mudaf* comes first and the *Mudaf Ilayh* after it.

3. The definition of the complex Murakkab Idafi

Definition: A *Murakkab Idafi* containing more than one *Mudaf* and *Mudaf Ilayh* is called a complex *Murakkab Idafi*.

بَابُ	بَيَّتْ	زَيَّدِ
Mudaf	Mudaf and Mudaf Ilayh — both	Mudaf Ilayh

(the door of the house of Zayd)

4. The structure of the chain

A complex *Murakkab Idafi* is really a construction in which a **chain** of nouns is formed, each noun establishing a connection with the one before it and the one after it.

Position	Standing
The first noun	is only a Mudaf
The middle nouns	have a double standing — Mudaf Ilayh for the noun before them, and Mudaf for the noun after them
The last noun	is only a Mudaf Ilayh

In this way the middle nouns, standing as *Mudaf Ilayh* on one side and as *Mudaf* on the other, join the whole construction into a single series.

Both sets of rules apply to the middle noun

Rule: Both the rules of the *Mudaf* and those of the *Mudaf Ilayh* apply to the middle noun. That is, like a *Mudaf* it takes neither **أَلْ** nor *Tanween*; and like a *Mudaf Ilayh* it is **always in the state of jarr**.

Determining the I'raab

The state of *I'raab* of a complex *Murakkab Idafi* is likewise determined by the *Mudaf*, that is, by the very first noun, since all the remaining nouns, being *Mudaf Ilayh*, are always in the state of *jarr*.

5. Examples of the complex Murakkab Idafi

Construction	Translation	Number of nouns
بِنْتُ رَسُولِ اللَّهِ	the daughter of the Messenger of Allah	three
مَالِكُ يَوْمِ الدِّينِ	the Master of the Day of Recompense	three
كَثْرَةُ ذِكْرِ الْمَوْتِ	the abundance of the remembrance of death	three
سُنَّةُ رَسُولِ اللَّهِ	the way of the Messenger of Allah	three
آيَاتُ كِتَابِ اللَّهِ	the verses of the Book of Allah	three
بُيُوتُ مُسْلِمِي الْمَدِينَةِ	the houses of the Muslims of Madinah	three

Construction	Translation	Number of nouns
شِرْكُ كَافِرِي مَكَّةَ	the associating of the disbelievers of Makkah	three
دُعَاءُ بِنْتِ رَسُولِ اللَّهِ	the supplication of the daughter of the Messenger of Allah	four

The Qur'anic form: In Surah al-Fatihah this construction appears as مَالِكِ يَوْمِ الدِّينِ, that is, with the *Mudaf Majroor*, because it follows الرَّحْمَنِ الرَّحِيمِ before it. Standing alone, مَالِكُ may also be *Marfoo'*.

A closer look at Muslimee and Kafiiree

In these two examples the middle noun is a *Jam' Salim Mudhakkar*. The noon of مُسْلِمُونَ and كَافِرُونَ has dropped because they are the *Mudaf*; and since they are themselves also the *Mudaf Ilayh*, they have taken the form of the state of *jarr* — مُسْلِمِي and كَافِرِي.

6. Analysis of the hadith

Two *Murakkabat Naqisah* are used in this hadith.

6.1 Yawm al-Qiyamah

Element	Details
يَوْمَ	the Mudaf — it carries neither al- nor Tanween
الْقِيَامَةِ	the Mudaf Ilayh — it is Majroor and carries al- as well
Count	there are only two nouns

Conclusion: This is a simple Murakkab Idafi, not a complex one.

Translation: the Day of Resurrection

6.2 Qadama ibn Adam

Element	Details
قَدَمَا	the Mudaf. It is the dual of قَدَمٌ, namely قَدَمَانِ, and its noon has dropped because it is the Mudaf
ابْنِ	a double standing — it is the Mudaf Ilayh of قَدَمَا, so it is Majroor; and it is the Mudaf of آدَمَ, so it carries neither al- nor Tanween
آدَمَ	only a Mudaf Ilayh, and it is Majroor
Count	there are three nouns

Conclusion: This is a complex Murakkab Idafi, because it contains more than one Mudaf and Mudaf Ilayh.

Translation: the two feet of the son of Adam

A closer look at the word Ibn

- ابْنِ means son.
- Its hamzah is a *Hamzat ul Wasl*, which is why it is not pronounced when joined and the reading is قَدَمَا ابْنِ. This point was covered in Lecture 15.
- Its feminine is ابْنَةٌ.
- Its dual comes as ابْنَانِ and ابْنَيْنِ.

Why does Adam carry neither al- nor Tanween?

Two reasons: First: it is an *Ism ul 'Alam*, and *alif lam* does not come upon an *Ism ul 'Alam*. Second: it is a *Ghayr Munsarif* noun, and *Tanween* does not come upon a *Ghayr Munsarif*. This is why, despite being *Majroor*, it carries a fathah and not a kasrah.

7. Translating a complex Murakkab Idafi

A complex *Murakkab Idafi* is translated by the same principle as a simple one. The only difference is that here the nouns are more numerous, so the order must be watched carefully.

The rule of translation: The translation always **begins from the last noun**, since that is the final *Mudaf Ilayh*. After it comes the noun of double standing, and last of all the first noun, which is only a *Mudaf*. English joins them with "of", and Urdu with "ka, ki, ke".

A worked example

Order	Word	Translation	Standing
first	آدَمَ	Adam	only Mudaf Ilayh
then	ابْنِ	the son	Mudaf and Mudaf Ilayh
last	قَدَمًا	the two feet	only Mudaf

Establishing the relation of *idafah* between the three gives the complete translation: **the two feet of the son of Adam**.

8. A full analysis of Bintu Rasulillah

بِنْتُ رَسُولِ اللَّهِ

(the daughter of the Messenger of Allah)

Three nouns are included in this construction, and since they number more than two, it is a complex *Murakkab Idafi*.

Element by element

Element	Details
بِنْتُ	meaning daughter. It carries neither al- nor Tanween, so it is only a Mudaf

Element	Details
رَسُولٍ	it is Majroor and it too carries neither al- nor Tanween. From this it is known that it is not merely a Mudaf Ilayh but has the standing of both Mudaf Ilayh and Mudaf — Mudaf Ilayh for بِنْتُ and Mudaf for اللَّهِ
اللَّهِ	the Ism ul Jalalah. It is Majroor and is only a Mudaf Ilayh, and the construction ends upon it

Conclusion: بِنْتُ is the Mudaf, رَسُولٍ is both Mudaf Ilayh and Mudaf, and اللَّهُ is only a Mudaf Ilayh.

In translating, the order is reversed: first اللَّهُ, then رَسُولٍ, and last بِنْتُ, giving the complete rendering: the daughter of the Messenger of Allah.

A construction of four nouns

دُعَاءُ بِنْتِ رَسُولِ اللَّهِ

(the supplication of the daughter of the Messenger of Allah)

دُعَاءُ	بِنْتِ	رَسُولِ	اللَّهِ
only Mudaf	Mudaf and Mudaf Ilayh	Mudaf and Mudaf Ilayh	only Mudaf Ilayh

Here four nouns are joined to one another through *idafah*, and two of them carry a double standing. However long the chain grows, the principle remains the same.

9. Another Murakkab Naqis in place of the Mudaf Ilayh

Rule: In a *Murakkab Idafi*, some other *Murakkab Naqis* may come in the position of the *Mudaf Ilayh*.

Construction	Translation	Explanation
ابْنُ الرَّجُلِ الصَّالِحِ	the son of the righteous man	ابْنُ الرَّجُلِ الصَّالِحِ is a Murakkab Tawsifi serving as the Mudaf Ilayh of ابْنُ
رَسُولُ اللَّهِ الْكَرِيمِ	the Messenger of Allah the Generous	رَسُولُ اللَّهِ الْكَرِيمِ is a Murakkab Tawsifi serving as the Mudaf Ilayh of رَسُولُ
نِعْمَةُ اللَّهِ الْعَظِيمِ	the favour of Allah the Magnificent	here too a Murakkab Tawsifi has come in the place of the Mudaf Ilayh

A point of recognition: In all three the third word is a *Sifah* and not a *Mudaf Ilayh*. It is known by this: it carries اَلْ and its *l'raab* is the same as that of the second word. Were it a *Mudaf Ilayh*, it would carry no *alif lam*, or else the second word would itself have become a *Mudaf* and been free of *alif lam*.

10. When does a Ghayr Munsarif noun accept a kasrah?

In Lecture 11 it was learnt that a *Ghayr Munsarif* noun takes neither *Tanween* nor a kasrah, being *Majroor* with a fathah instead. But there are two cases in which it does accept a kasrah.

#	The case	Example
1	When alif lam enters the Ghayr Munsarif noun	مِنَ الْمَسَاجِدِ
2	When the Ghayr Munsarif noun comes as a Mudaf	فِي مَسَاجِدِ اللَّهِ

Against this, the word *آدَمَ* in the hadith is a *Mudaf Ilayh* and not a *Mudaf*, and carries no *alif lam* either. That is why it does not accept a kasrah and remained *Majroor* with a fathah.

11. The complete list of the Murakkabat Naqisah

Three *Murakkabat Naqisah* have so far been studied in detail. The scholars of *Nahw* set out six kinds in all, whose complete list is given below.

Kind	Definition	Example
Murakkab Tawsifi	in which the second noun states a quality of the first	الْوَلَدُ الصَّالِحُ
Murakkab Idafi	in which one noun is related to another	بَيْتُ زَيْدٍ
Murakkab Isharee	in which the Asma' ul Isharah are used	هَذَا الْكِتَابُ
Murakkab Bina'i	a Murakkab Naqis whose second element includes a Harf ul 'Atf. It is also called Murakkab Ta'dadi	أَحَدَ عَشَرَ
Murakkab Man' Sarf	a construction in which two words have been joined into one without idafah and without predication. It is also called Murakkab Mazji	بَعْلَبَكْ
Murakkab Sawti	a Murakkab Naqis by which an animal is called, or by which the sound of a living or lifeless thing is imitated	نَحْ نَحْ ، غَاقٍ غَاقٍ

- نَحْ نَحْ is the sound used to make a camel kneel, and غَاقٍ غَاقٍ is the cawing of a crow.
- Both elements of a *Murakkab Bina'i* are *Mabni* upon a fathah, except اِثْنَا عَشَرَ, whose first element is *Mu'rab*. This point was met in Lecture 11.
- The first element of a *Murakkab Man' Sarf* is *Mabni* upon a fathah, and its second element is *Mu'rab* and *Ghayr Munsarif*.

A principle common to all: None of these *Murakkabat Naqisah* is a complete sentence; each always forms one element of a sentence.

12. How a Murakkab Naqis becomes an element of a sentence

A *Murakkab Naqis* does not itself form a sentence, but it certainly plays some part in one. Sometimes it becomes the *Mubtada*, sometimes the *Khabar*, and sometimes the *Fa'il* in a *Jumla Fi'liyyah*.

Sentence	The Murakkab Naqis	Its part in the sentence
جَاءَ طَعَامُ زَيْدٍ	طَعَامُ زَيْدٍ	a Murakkab Idafi serving as the Fa'il of the verb جَاءَ
جَاءَ رَجُلٌ عَالِمٌ	رَجُلٌ عَالِمٌ	a Murakkab Tawsifi serving as the Fa'il of the verb جَاءَ

Sentence	The Murakkab Naqis	Its part in the sentence
هَذَا الْكِتَابُ جَدِيدٌ	هَذَا الْكِتَابُ	a Murakkab Isharee serving as the Mubtada of a Jumla Ismiyyah

In the first two examples the whole *Murakkab Naqis* takes the place of the *Fa'il* and, together with the verb, forms a complete *Jumla Fi'liyyah*. In the third, the *Murakkab Isharee* became the *Mubtada* and, with its *Khabar*, completed a *Jumla Ismiyyah*.

Summary

1. A Murakkab Idafi containing more than one Mudaf and Mudaf Ilayh is called a complex Murakkab Idafi.
2. In it a chain of nouns is formed, each establishing a connection with the noun before it and the one after it.
3. The first noun is only a Mudaf and the last noun is only a Mudaf Ilayh.
4. The middle nouns carry a double standing: Mudaf Ilayh for the one before, and Mudaf for the one after.
5. Both sets of rules apply to the middle noun: no al-, no Tanween, and it stays always in the state of jarr.
6. The l'raab of a complex Murakkab Idafi is likewise determined by the Mudaf, that is, by the first noun.
7. In the hadith, **يَوْمَ الْقِيَامَةِ** is a simple Murakkab Idafi while **قَدَمَا ابْنِ آدَمَ** is a complex one.
8. **قَدَمَا** is really **قَدَمَانِ**, whose noon dropped because it is the Mudaf.
9. The hamzah of **ابْنِ** is a Hamzat ul Wasl, its feminine is **ابْنَةٍ**, and its dual is **ابْنَانِ** and **ابْنَيْنِ**.
10. **آدَمَ** carries no al- because it is an Ism ul 'Alam, and no Tanween because it is Ghayr Munsarif; hence it carries a fathah despite being Majroor.
11. The translation always begins from the last noun, then the middle noun, and last the first noun.
12. In **بُنْتُ رَسُولِ اللَّهِ**, **بُنْتُ** is the Mudaf, **رَسُولِ** holds both standings, and **اللَّهُ** is only a Mudaf Ilayh.
13. In **دُعَاءُ بُنْتِ رَسُولِ اللَّهِ** four nouns are joined and two of them carry a double standing.
14. Another Murakkab Naqis may come in the place of the Mudaf Ilayh, as the Murakkab Tawsifi does in **ابْنُ الرَّجُلِ الصَّالِحِ**.
15. A Ghayr Munsarif noun accepts a kasrah in two cases: when al- enters it, and when it comes as a Mudaf.
16. There are six kinds of Murakkabat Naqisah: Tawsifi, Idafi, Isharee, Bina'i, Man' Sarf and Sawti.
17. The Murakkab Bina'i is also called Murakkab Ta'dadi, and the Murakkab Man' Sarf is also called Murakkab Mazji.
18. A Murakkab Sawti is one by which an animal is called or a sound is imitated, as in **نَحْنُ نَحْ** and **غَايِ غَايِ**.
19. None of the Murakkabat Naqisah is a complete sentence; each always forms one element of a sentence.
20. A Murakkab Naqis may serve as the Fa'il in a sentence, as **جَاءَ طَعَامُ زَيْدٍ** does in **جَاءَ طَعَامُ زَيْدٍ**.

Exercise

1. Define the complex Murakkab Idafi and show its chain by means of an example.
2. State separately the standing of the first, the middle and the last noun in a complex Murakkab Idafi.
3. Which two sets of rules apply to the middle noun?
4. By what is the l'raab of a complex Murakkab Idafi determined, and why?

5. Take both Murakkabat Naqisah from the hadith and state the difference between them.
6. Give a full analysis of قَدَمَا ابْنِ آدَمَ.
7. Write four things about the word ابْن.
8. Why does آدَمَ carry neither al- nor Tanween? Give both reasons.
9. Write the rule for translating a complex Murakkab Idafi and apply it to قَدَمَا ابْنِ آدَمَ.
10. State separately the standing of each of the three nouns in بِنْتُ رَسُولِ اللَّهِ.
11. Which nouns carry a double standing in دُعَاءُ بِنْتِ رَسُولِ اللَّهِ?
12. In مُسْلِمِي الْمَدِينَةِ, why did the noon drop and why did the yaa' come?
13. Write three examples in which a Murakkab Tawsifi comes in the place of the Mudaf Ilayh.
14. In which two cases does a Ghayr Munsarif noun accept a kasrah? Give an example of each.
15. Write the six kinds of Murakkabat Naqisah with their definitions and examples.
16. How does a Murakkab Naqis become an element of a sentence? Explain with three examples.

سُبْحَانَكَ اللَّهُمَّ وَبِحَمْدِكَ، أَشْهَدُ أَنْ لَا إِلَهَ إِلَّا أَنْتَ، أَسْتَغْفِرُكَ وَأَتُوبُ إِلَيْكَ

اللَّهُمَّ صَلِّ عَلَى مُحَمَّدٍ وَعَلَى آلِ مُحَمَّدٍ كَمَا صَلَّيْتَ عَلَى إِبْرَاهِيمَ وَعَلَى آلِ إِبْرَاهِيمَ إِنَّكَ حَمِيدٌ مَجِيدٌ

اللَّهُمَّ بَارِكْ عَلَى مُحَمَّدٍ وَعَلَى آلِ مُحَمَّدٍ كَمَا بَارَكْتَ عَلَى إِبْرَاهِيمَ وَعَلَى آلِ إِبْرَاهِيمَ إِنَّكَ حَمِيدٌ مَجِيدٌ